Mahatma Gandhi University, Kottayam
MGU-UGP (Honours) Regular Examinations
Third Semester
MG3DSEENG201: Reading Culture: Food, Travel and Music
(2024 Admission Onwards)

Duration: 2 Hrs **Marks: 70**

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall attainability of the outcomes.

Part A

I. Multiple Choice Questions. Each question carries one mark. (1 X10= 10 Marks)

1. Why does Tara continue to eat the peppermint chocolates even when she dislikes them? [CO1, K]
    a. She doesn't want to upset Abhay
    b. She loves all types of chocolate
    c. She is addicted to the idea of eating
    d. She thinks it's good for identity
2. How does Swift use Gulliver's travel to Lilliput to critique European colonisation? [CO4, U]
    a. By showing Lilliput as a utopia
    b. By making Gulliver a conqueror
    c. By showing a giant subdued by tiny but organised people
    d. By erasing European references entirely
3. Rajyashri Goody's first recipe booklet is titled [CO1, K]
    a. Hungry Belly
    b. Is Hunger Gnawing at Your Belly?
    c. Cry of Hunger
    d. Are you Hungry?
4. Who composed the rap version of the Poromboke song? [CO2, K]
    a. Vedan
    b. Arivu
    c. Kaber Vasuki
    d. Dabzee
5. By whom was Bob Dylan deeply influenced? [CO2, K]
    a. Woody Allen
    b. Woodrow Wilson
    c. Woody Guthrie
    d. Peter, Paul and Mary
6. How does the song's refrain, "Make it a better place" function? [CO2, U]
    a. It demands immediate action
    b. It calls for collective responsibility and hope
    c. It describes personal struggles
    d. It dismissed global issues
7. How does Iyer distinguish a traveller from a tourist? [CO3, U]

a. Travellers book longer stays; tourists take short trips
b. Tourists seek cultural learning, while travellers don't
c. Tourists carry guidebooks, while travellers rely on locals
d. Travellers leave assumptions at home; tourists do not

8. How does Theroux describe his fellow travellers on the train? [CO3, K]
   a. Silent and uninterested in conversation
   b. A mix of ordinary people and eccentric characters
   c. Mostly happy tourists eager to see monuments'
   d. Young students on a study tour
9. Why did the Polo brothers decide to visit Venice before returning to the Khan? [CO3, U]
   a. To recruit soldiers
   b. To deliver holy oil from Jerusalem
   c. To visit their families while waiting for a new pope
   d. To gather spices for trade.
10. Who is Rahman's younger sister? [CO4, K]
    a. Fathima
    b. Raihanah
    c. Kareena
    d. Ameena

Part B

II. Answer *any six* in about 100 words. Each question carries 5 marks. (5x6= 30 marks)

11. Describe Tara's life before marriage in terms of her education and upbringing. [CO1, K]
12. What is the symbolic significance of Sulaimani in *Ustad Hotel*? [CO1, U]
13. Identify the Carnatic ragas used in T M Krishna's PorombokePaadal. [CO2, K]
14. Discuss the cultural and literary significance of Bob Dylan. [CO2, U]
15. How does Swift use Gulliver's perspective as a foreigner to expose the absurdities of Lilliputian society—and, by extension, of European society? [CO4, An]
16. Analyse the character of Molesworth and his role in the travel narrative. [CO3, An]
17. What is the significance of the golden tablet given by the Great Khan? [CO3, U]
18. Describe how the author's family used food to maintain their cultural identity in a foreign land in "Indian Takeout" [CO4, U]
19. What was the impact of Rahman on sound in Indian cinema? [CO4, U]

Part C

III. Answer any *two* in 300 words. Each question carries 15 marks. (15x2=30 marks)

20. How do *Salt N' Pepper* and *Ustad Hotel* engage with the themes of globalisation and liberalisation? [CO1, U]
21. Critically explain the "Anti-Hero" and the cultural impact of the Swifties and their metaverse. [CO2, U]

22. Examine the cultural dynamics in *The Great Railway Bazaar.* How does train travel serve as a symbol of emotional and cultural nourishment across diverse societies? [CO3, U]

23. Analyse the intersections of food, memory, and migration in JhumpaLahiri's essay prescribed. How does food act as both comfort and resistance? [CO4, An]